Installing PostgreSQL on Mac OS

PostgreSQL can be installed in a variety of ways on Mac OS. The recommended method is to use PostgresApp https://postgresapp.com. This is a native Mac OS application. The installation process is the same for any installation with a .dmg extension. Download the file using a browser, and double click it to start the installation process.

Installing PostgreSQL using Homebrew or another method is also perfectly fine. If you're comfortable doing that, go for it.

Along with the PostgreSQL server installation, you'll get additional PostgreSQL Client Applications like pg_dump and psql[2].

After installing PostgreSQL in one of the ways above, check the versions of your client programs. This helps you verify they're installed properly. Run the following commands from your Terminal.

```
psql --version
pg_dump --version
```

With your PostgreSQL server instance started, open up your terminal and type psql to connect to a default database that matches your OS username, as a user (role) that's your username. If your Mac OS username is andy (type: whoami) without any arguments to psql, it will try and connect to a database called andy with a user andy. If you see a psql prompt, you know you're connected. You may type SELECT current_database(); to view the current database you're connected to. Type \q to quit.

With your PostgreSQL server instance running, and being able to connect to it for any database, you're ready to proceed to work on getting the Ruby language installed, and then the Rideshare Rails app installed.

Installing and Configuring Your Ruby Environment

Rideshare is a Ruby application, so you'll need Ruby running on your computer. From your Terminal, type ruby -v to see if you already have a version of Ruby installed. Regardless, you'll need the specific version that's supported by Rideshare. To find the specific version, Ruby apps have a convention to place the version in a file in the root directory called ~/.ruby-version. Ruby Version Managers were created to help you install and manage multiple versions of Ruby installed at the same time. When a version is detected, the version manager should automatically switch to that version.

2. https://www.postgresql.org/docs/current/reference-client.html